

Miner Baseball—

Cohens Need: 'One Pitch Ahead'

By PETE CICCARELLI

After his legendary New York Yankees fumbled away a ballgame early in the 1956 American League season, manager Casey Stengel appraised the setback thusly: "Our mental condition cost us," the 'Ol Perfessor' intoned in the most proper 'Stengelese'. "It's early in the year and our brain waves are still too slow."

Yesterday Andy Cohen found out what Casey meant.

Cohen's University of Texas at El Paso baseball team opened the 1974 regular season by "flunking" a double-header with Hardin-Simmons, 8-5 and 7-4.

"This is terribly disappointing," Andy reflected. "Our inexperience cost us some important runs. We made some physical errors but the mental errors were the ones that hurt us."

A PAIR of mis-directed outfield relays in the opener and a trail runner getting picked

off first base in the nightcap led the Miners' opening round double knockout but Cohen is not ready to toss in the towel, especially if the club could rebound in today's twinbill with HSU.

"We've got to look at this as a lesson," Andy commented. "We've got a lot of work to do, and we can't go about it half-heartedly."

The Miners five runs in the opener off southpaw Pete Gill were forged from just a half dozen hits the lanky Cowboy hurler allowed. Bob Downing's first homerun of the season, in the sixth, led to a 5-5 deadlock but HSU slipped across three tallies in the seventh off hardluck reliever Jeff Hogan to pick up its first win in five outings.

CECILEVANS scattered eight hits in the second game to stymie the Miners, negating a sound effort by Orange southpaw Mike Hilton. "Hilton threw well," Andy's brother Syd, who handles the hurlers, described. "He's like a lot of the other young kids, they have to learn to get one pitch ahead of the action and stay there."

Miner secondsacker Mark Miller, whose name is bound to be called in June's professional draft, tagged the ball hard all day but came away with a pair of singles. Mark twice backed HSU flyhawks to the boards and on another

occasion re-worked the stitching in Cowboy thirdbaseman Mike Brown's glove.

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FIRST GAME
HSU 8, COH 5
Pete Gill and Tom McPherson, David Jamieson, Jeff Hogan (4), Tony Madelin (7) and Jim Brundage W-Gill, (1-2) L-Hogan (0-1)
HR HSU Randy Davis (1), UTEP-Bob Downing (1)

SECOND GAME
HSU 7, COH 1
Cecil Evans and Bobby Kahn, Mike Hilton, Bob Knox (7) and Mike Miller, W-Evans (1-2) L-Hilton (0-1)